

# SIMNOVUS DRIVES INNOVATION IN 5G TECHNOLOGY

A visionary entrepreneur, Mr. Saurav Jha, President & CEO of Simnovus, strikes the right balance between tech expertise and business strategy. An engineering graduate from MIT, Manipal, and EGMP from IIM, Bangalore, the passionate entrepreneur excels in technology innovation, business growth and operations. A brilliant business strategy specialist, he is set to rule the cellular wireless industry!



**Mr. Saurav Jha**  
President & CEO, Simnovus

## What led to establishment of the Simnovus start-up?

Simnovus was co-founded in 2017 with a vision to disrupt 4G and 5G validation by enabling software innovation, which has been otherwise dominated by proprietary and bulky hardware extensive solutions, by traditional players. Our software focused solution accelerates the 5G based innovations, which our esteemed customer partners sought for, in order to maintain the edge in this ever-evolving technology space.

Today, our software based 5G UE Simulator solution is being used by 40 customers across the globe in countries such as the USA, India, Japan and Europe, and have ensured more than 100% growth in revenue YoY for Simnovus.

## What are your future plans and goals?

We aim to establish product led growth by keeping software innovation and technology research ahead of others. Our plan is to add more scalability to our current product, add 5G O-RAN capabilities and in near future, containerize our software solution and bring in SaaS model. We also plan to start our research in 6G technology, collaborate with a few leading universities and academicians, in order to create and manage a sustainable

ecosystem of start ups and disruptors in cellular wireless industry.

## Tell us about the uniqueness and customer feedback of Simnovus services or products?

Our product is based on software defined radio technology and it can be installed on any COTS server. Being hardware agnostic, its quick to deliver, easy to deploy, zero downtime, agile and facilitates faster support response. Apart from product and technical support, we also offer our customers to capitalize on our expertise- we partner with them to ensure their success.

This is the reason that we have almost 90% repeat customers with an average ARR of 60% per customer. Our customer end users are our brand ambassadors who spread the positive feedback within their organizations and also across the industry.

## What are the challenges that you have overcome to reach where you are today?

We followed a lean start approach where we first engaged with a few hand-full strategic customer labs and created them into our pilot projects, to evaluate our MVP. This exercise was almost 1.5 years long where we didn't make

any revenue, but gained a lot of feedback on product, its features, industry requirements and trends, pricing strategy etc. I think, this was the most crucial phase for us and it really strengthened our positioning in the market. Raising capital was the next challenge in order to execute our scale up strategy and accelerate growth. We had to ramp up our R&D, sales, open more revenue regions etc. It was quite challenging to raise money from India VC and investors community as our product is not B2C and not just India focused. We are a global company with a B2B software-based product with - deep niche tech - which is best appreciated in high innovation and R&D focused economies. We restructured to be a Delaware Corporation company in 2021 and got attention of VCs and angel investors, raising approx. \$1.5M in pre-series round and we aim for another \$3M in Series A, in CY 2022.

## What changes can make the industry more result-oriented?

The big change is already visible now, with 5G technology gaining momentum across the globe. There is more focus on open source and dis-aggregated RAN and Networks. All this results in accelerating innovation through software, and less dependency on proprietary hardware. What it means is that there is no better opportunity for start-ups to come up with innovative solutions and disrupt the telecom industry by providing smarter and cost-effective solutions. This is very important in order to strike a balance, as against the consolidation of a few big traditional players and their decades long dominance. In near future, we should see more small size and new disruptors even in operators' space, which will finally provide more and better options and services to the end users.

## What is your golden leadership quote?

Think big, start lean, engage customer partners, execute and then scale up. Forming the right founders' team, with the right balance of different skill sets, ambitions, goals and working style, is more efficient and sustainable as compared to a group of only ultra Hi-Tech engineers or just business professionals.